



△ THE TEMPLE OF ATHENA PARTHENOS

The Acropolis is perched on a rocky hill 490 ft (150 m) above sea level, with around 20 buildings remaining today. The largest of these, the Parthenon, equaled eight tennis courts in area.

◁ UNUSUAL COLUMNS

Sculpted female figures known as caryatids act as columns in the Erechtheion Temple to the north of the Parthenon.

OPTICAL ILLUSION

Due to a quirk of perspective, if built to a strictly rectilinear plan, the Parthenon would have appeared oddly out of alignment. To overcome this, the architects designed the building on a slightly domed base with gently curving lines and inward-leaning columns, which bulge slightly at their middles, a technique known as entasis. The corner columns are also a little wider than and closer to their neighbors than the inner columns. To avoid appearing to slope away from the viewer at ground level, the friezes are imperceptibly tilted forward.

